

Global Renewable Energy in 2025: How Far Have We Come?

Global renewable energy trends across primary energy and electricity

Audience: policy analysts and energy sector strategists

75% of Global GHG Emissions Still Come from Fossil Fuels

~75%

of global greenhouse gas emissions come from burning fossil fuels for energy

5M+

premature deaths per year from local air pollution caused by fossil fuel combustion

Renewables (plus nuclear) are central to cutting CO₂ and air pollution.

Modern renewables here exclude traditional biomass.

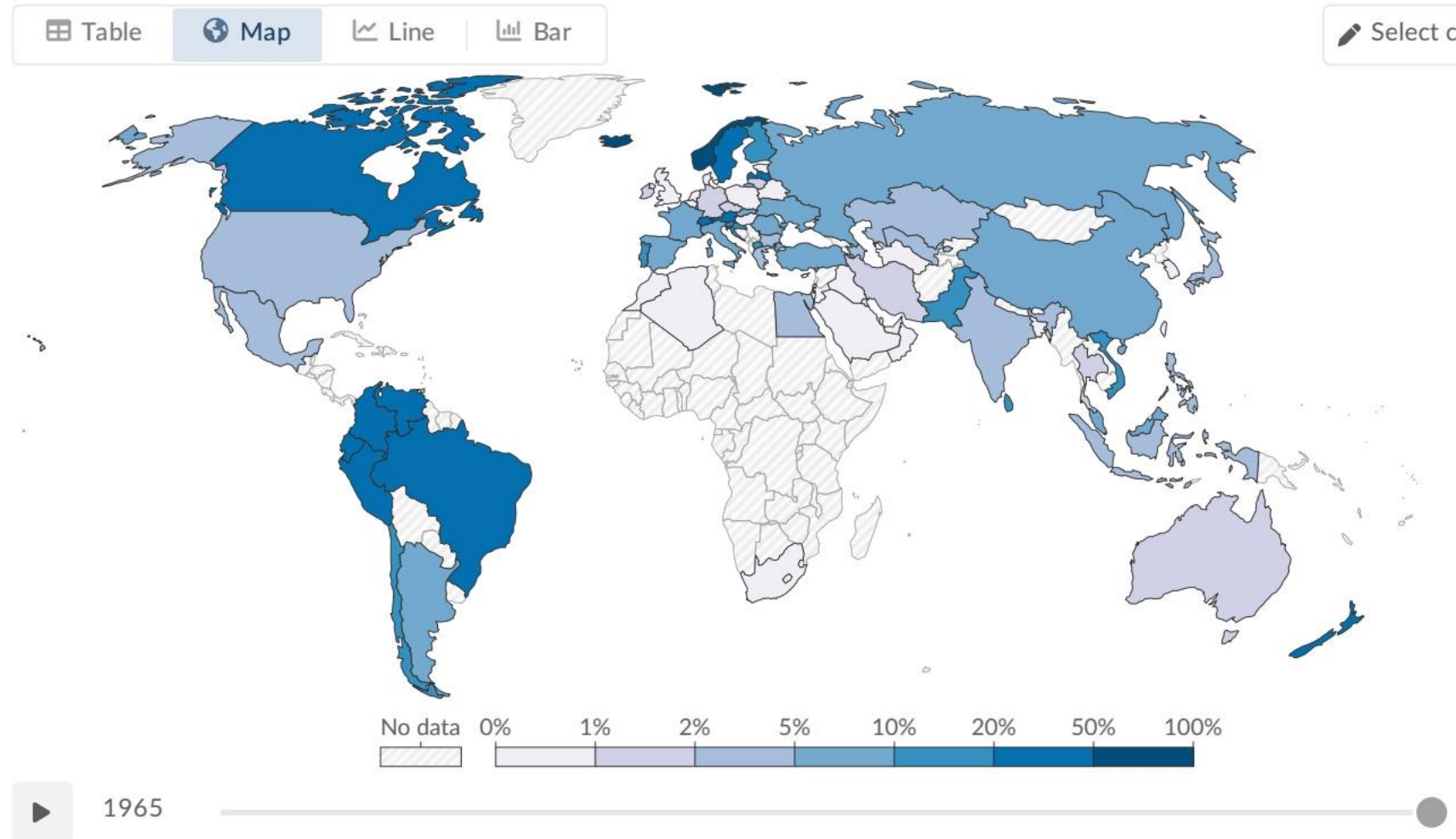
Renewables Now Supply ~14% of Global Primary

Energy

~14% of the world's primary energy comes from renewables (2024; substitution method)

Primary energy includes electricity + transport + heating—harder-to-decarbonize sector overall share lower.

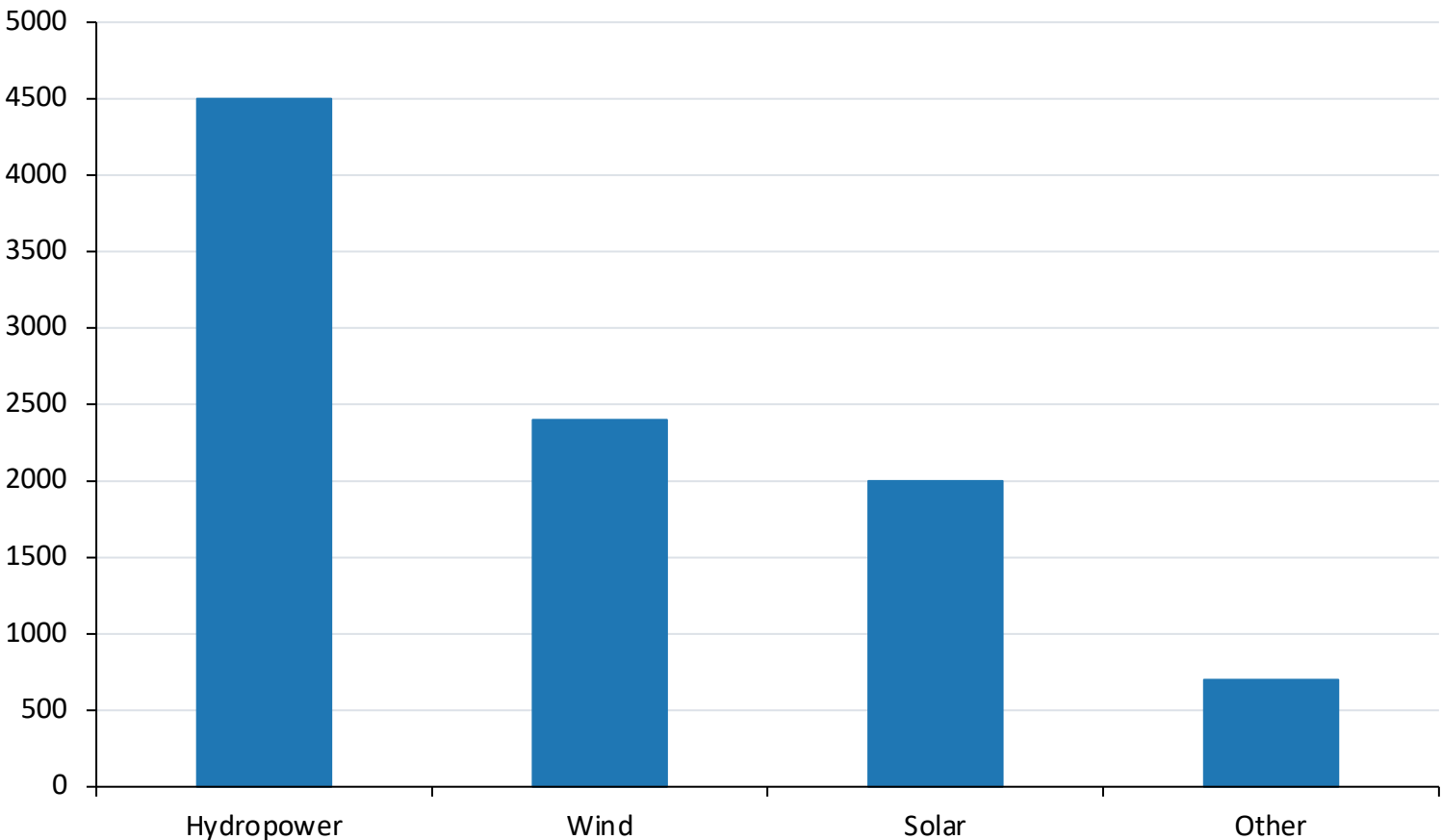
Large cross-country variation: high in Norway/Brazil/New Zealand; <5% in parts of Middle East and Asia.



Data source: Energy Institute - Statistical Review of World Energy (2025) – [Learn more about this data](#)
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Renewable Electricity Generation Is Growing Rapidly, Led by Wind and Solar

Generation (TWh, 2024)



Hydro remains #1, but wind + solar combined now nearly match hydro’s output.

Wind and solar have accelerated strongly since ~2010.

Technology	TWh (2024)	Share of renewable elec.
Hydropower	~4,500	~47%
Wind	~2,400	~25%
Solar	~2,000	~21%
Other	~700	~7%

Almost One-Third of Global Electricity Now Comes

Share of electricity production from renewables, 2025

Renewables include solar, wind, hydropower, bioenergy, geothermal, wave, and tidal sources.



World average: ~30% renewable electricity (2025).

Leaders: Brazil/Canada/Nordics at ~60–98%; many Middle Eastern and some African countries below 10%.

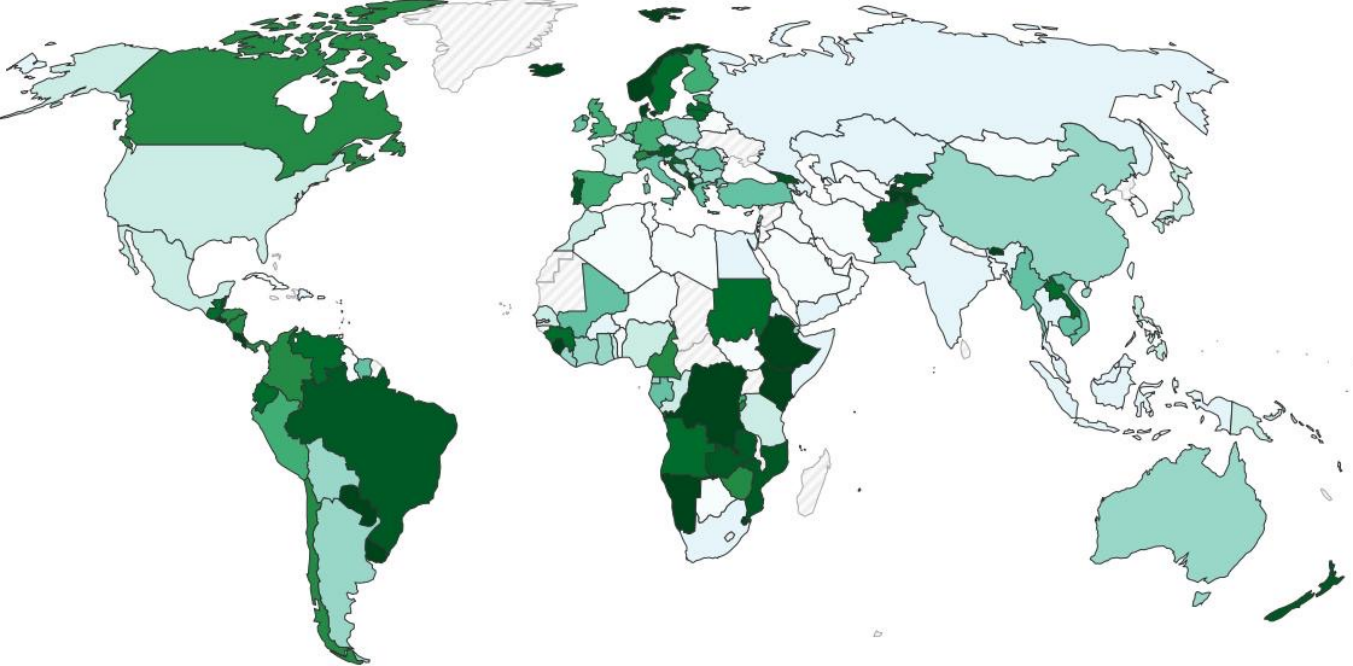
Table

Map

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Select countries



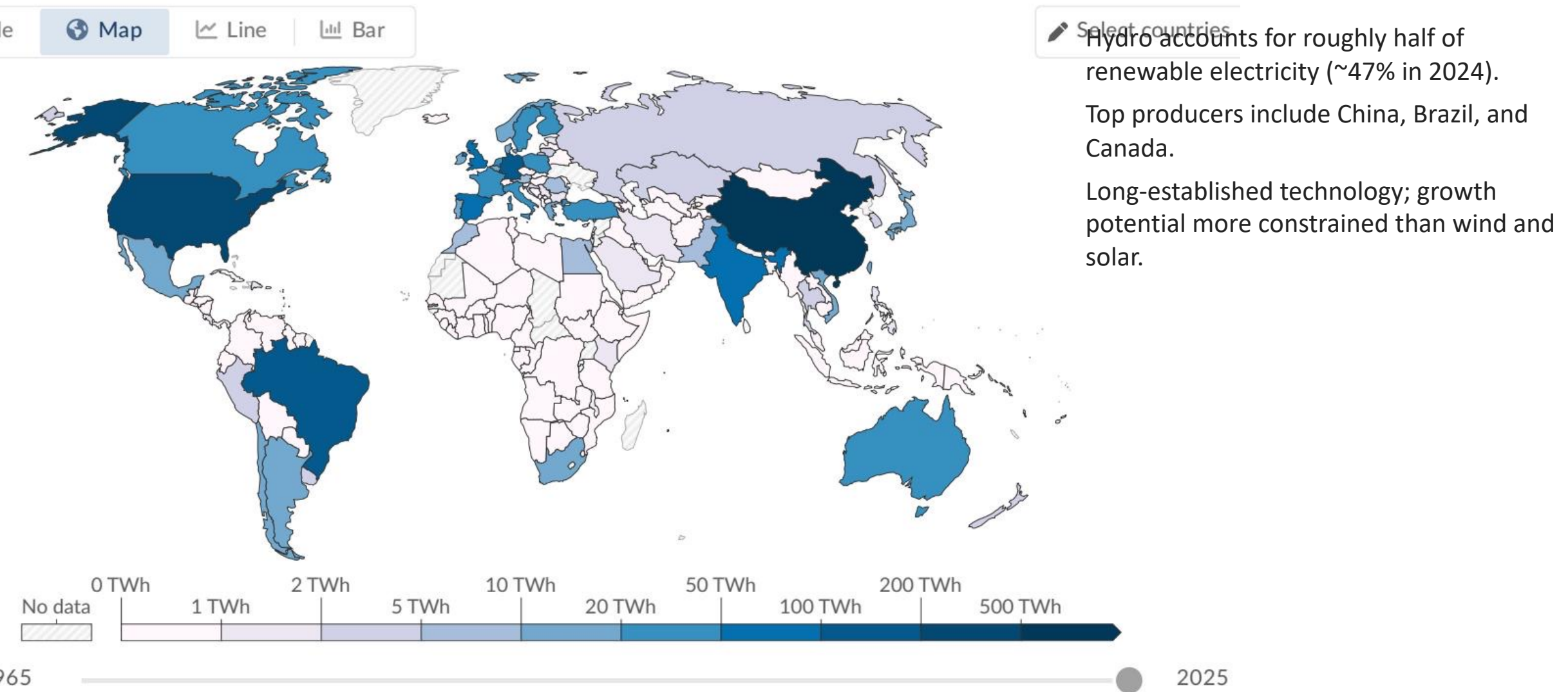
Data source: Ember (2026); Energy Institute - Statistical Review of World Energy (2025) – [Learn more about this data](#)

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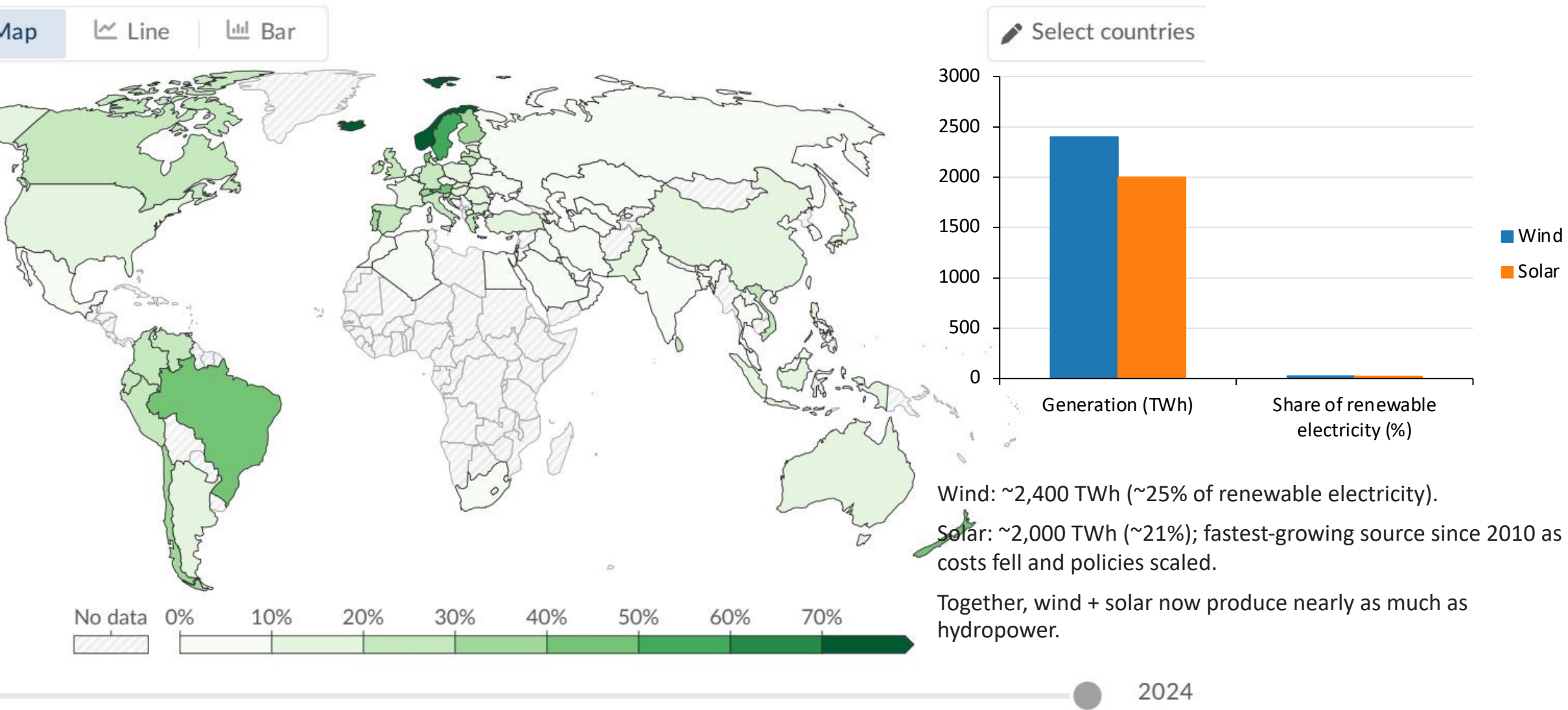


Country/Region	Renewable electricity
Norway	~98%
Brazil	~85%
Canada	~65%
China	~35%
India	~25%
Saudi Arabia	<2%

Hydropower Remains the Largest Renewable Source at ~50% of Generation

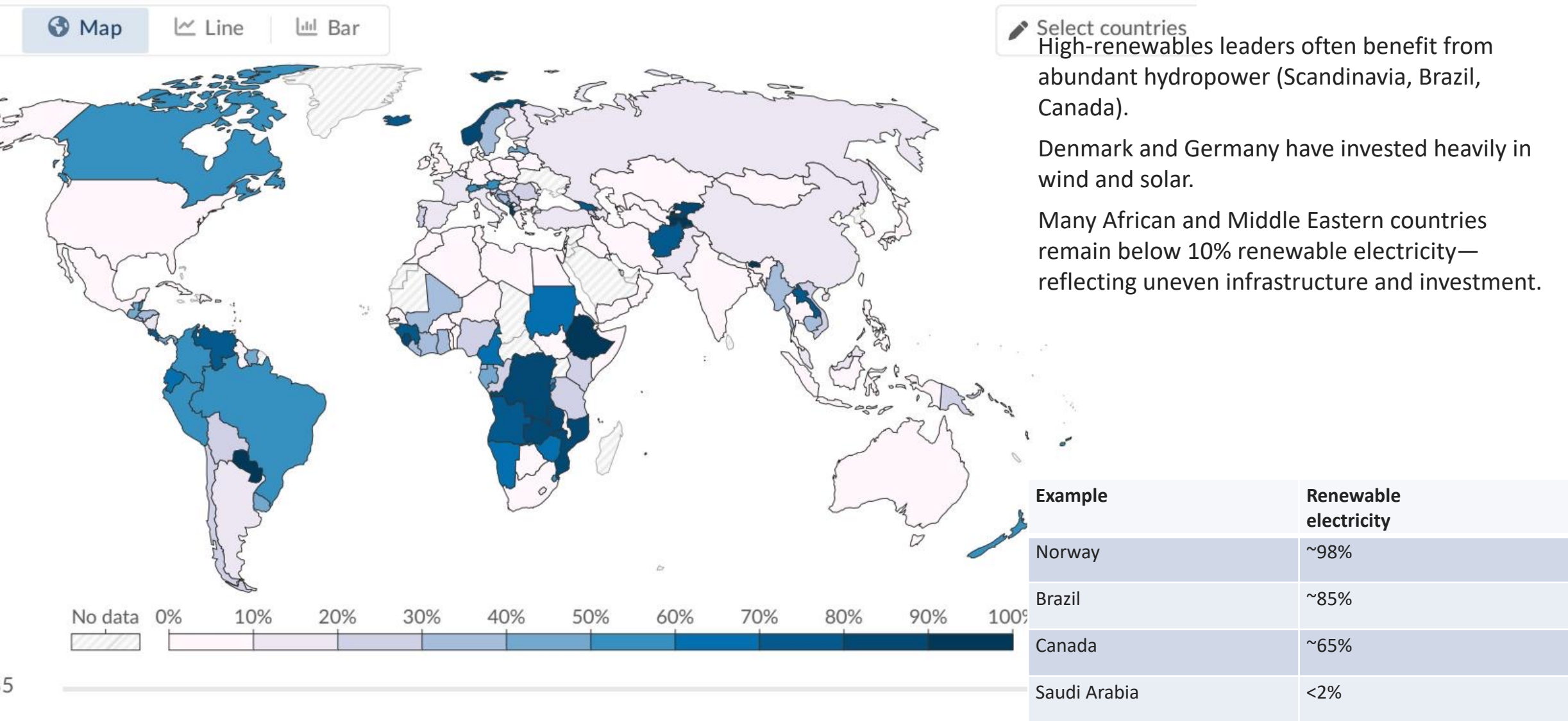


Wind and Solar Are the Fastest-Growing Energy



Source: Our World in Data (Renewable Energy); Ember (2026); Energy Institute (2025)

Stark Regional Gaps: Sub-Saharan Africa Lags While



Source: Our World in Data (Renewable Energy); Ember (2026); Energy Institute (2025)

Key Takeaways: Renewables Are Growing Fast but the Transition Must Accelerate

Renewables are ~14% of global primary energy (2024) and ~30% of electricity (2025).

Hydropower still provides roughly half of renewable electricity, but wind and solar are catching up fast.

Wind (~2,400 TWh; ~25%) and solar (~2,000 TWh; ~21%) are scaling rapidly—together nearly matching hydro output.

Regional disparities remain wide: many countries exceed 60–90% renewable electricity, while others remain below 10%.

Transport and heating lag electricity—raising the urgency to broaden decarbonization beyond the power sector.

Forward look: scaling grids, finance, and policy can turn rapid electricity progress into an economy-wide transition.